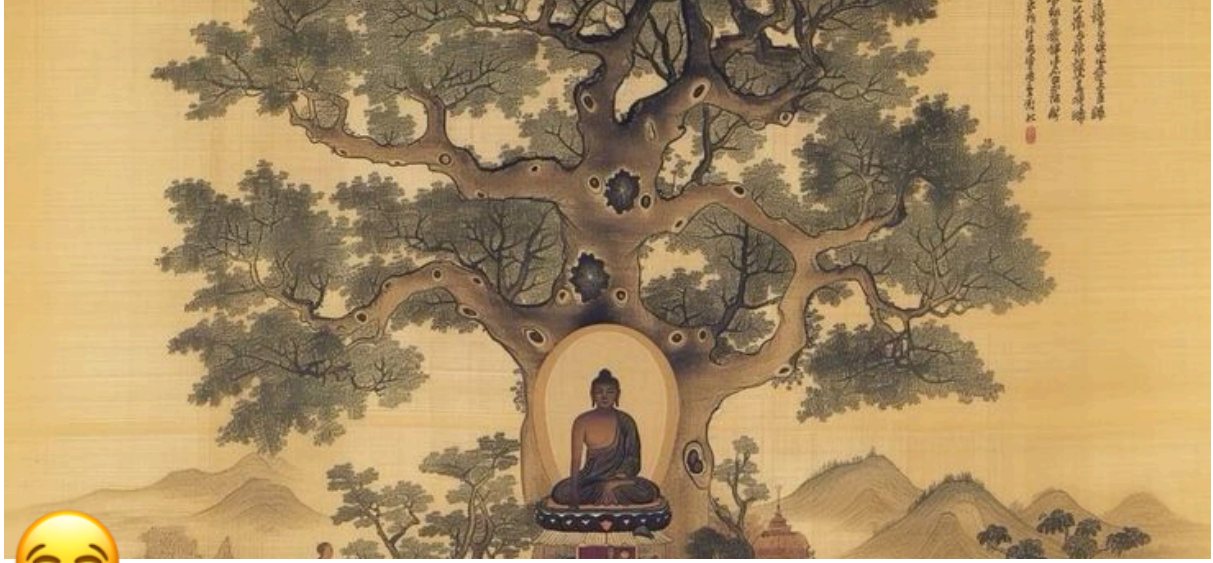




Vrittis

*"yogena chittasya padena vacham
malam sharirasya cha vaidyakena
yo'pakarottamam pravaram muninam
patanjalin pranjaliranato'smi"*

The 5 vrittis types

We have seen that vrittis can be both painful and non-painful. We will now study the 5 types of vrittis that exist. Sutra I.6 lists these 5 categories of mental fluctuation.

I.6 Pramana-viparyaya-vikalpa-nidra-smrtayah

1. **Pramāna**: right reasoning (I.7)
2. **Viparyaya**: erroneous thinking (I.8)
3. **Vikalpa**: imagination (I.9)
4. **Nidrā**: sleep (I.10)

5. **Smriti:** memory; souvenirs (I.11)



"Vrittis hinds the Truth like a water drop dripples a quiet lake"

Pramāna: right reasoning

To reason correctly, you need to be able to observe and analyze, but also not to rely entirely on yourself, so you need to refer to the wisdom of the elders.

Viparyaya: erroneous thinking

Erroneous thinking or illusion is due to the confusion of one object for another. This confusion is based on a distorted observation of reality. Misconception generates false impressions and will cloud the sadhakas vision, slowing him down on his path to Purusa. We naturally think we're never wrong. Let's say you saw a snake in a cave when in fact it was just a rope...

Pramana and Viparyaya come from observing the outside world.

Vikalpa: imagination

In imagination, we observe an object that is not present. This is projection. It's human nature, especially in Western culture, to plans for the future.

This is not bad in itself, for if Vikalpa is used to apply itself to the acquisition of knowledge through analysis, experimentation (trial and error), and determination, then it can awaken a real thirst to learn True Knowledge and disillusionment can be transformed into vision and exploration. Without this process, Vikalpa will remain imagination without substance.

Nidrā: sleep

Are we in a state of samadhi when we sleep deeply?

Nidra is a vritti, so the True Self is not experienced, since there is no experience. This is why we are not in Samadhi when we sleep deeply.

There are three types of sleep:

- **Heavy, dull sleep** : tamasic sleep.
- **Restless sleep** : rajastic sleep.
- **Light, soothing, clear sleep** : sattvic sleep.

Sleep is a state in which manas (mind), the king of the senses, is at rest. This state is called abhavam, the state of emptiness, the feeling of emptiness. The sadhaka tries to transform this state of rest while awake, with the aim of controlling and attenuate his vrittis and thus attain Kaivalya.

Viklapa and Nidra contribute to the creation of dreams.

Smriti: memory

Smriti is a compilation of the modulations and impressions of the other 4 vrittis. If our perception is tainted, our memory can be altered. When we are nostalgic, for example, our memories make us regret a period that makes us sad. If, however, we use our memory transparently, we are able to recall our experiences in their true state. This skill is a foundation for the practice of one's intellect (distinction).

How can I appease our vrittis ? Sutra I.12 answers this question:

I.12 "Abhyasa-vairagyabhyam tan-nirodhah"

"Stopping automatic thoughts is achieved through intense practice in a spirit of letting go."

abhyasa: practice, work on oneself requiring effort and willpower

vairagya: absence passion, attachment, not getting emotionally involved;

nirodha: cessation, interruption, suppression.

In other words, **practice** (Abhyasa) and **detachment** (Vairagya) are **the keys to stopping the fluctuations of the mind**.

The study of consciousness and its calming represent practice (Abhyasa). This is the positive side of yoga, while detachment or renunciation (Vairagya) is the negative side.

Abhyasa implies an intense, evolving practice that leads to the discovery of the Self (the first 4 stages of Yoga sutra I.13). The involutive path of Vairagya (the last 4 stages of Yoga) detaches consciousness from external objects. And the moon (Vairagya).

I.13 "Tatra Sthitau yatno'bhyasa"

"In this case, this intense practice is an energetic effort to establish oneself within oneself."

tatra: there, then, in that case

Sthitau: to be established, to root

stha: to stand

yatna: effort, energy
abhyasa: intense practice

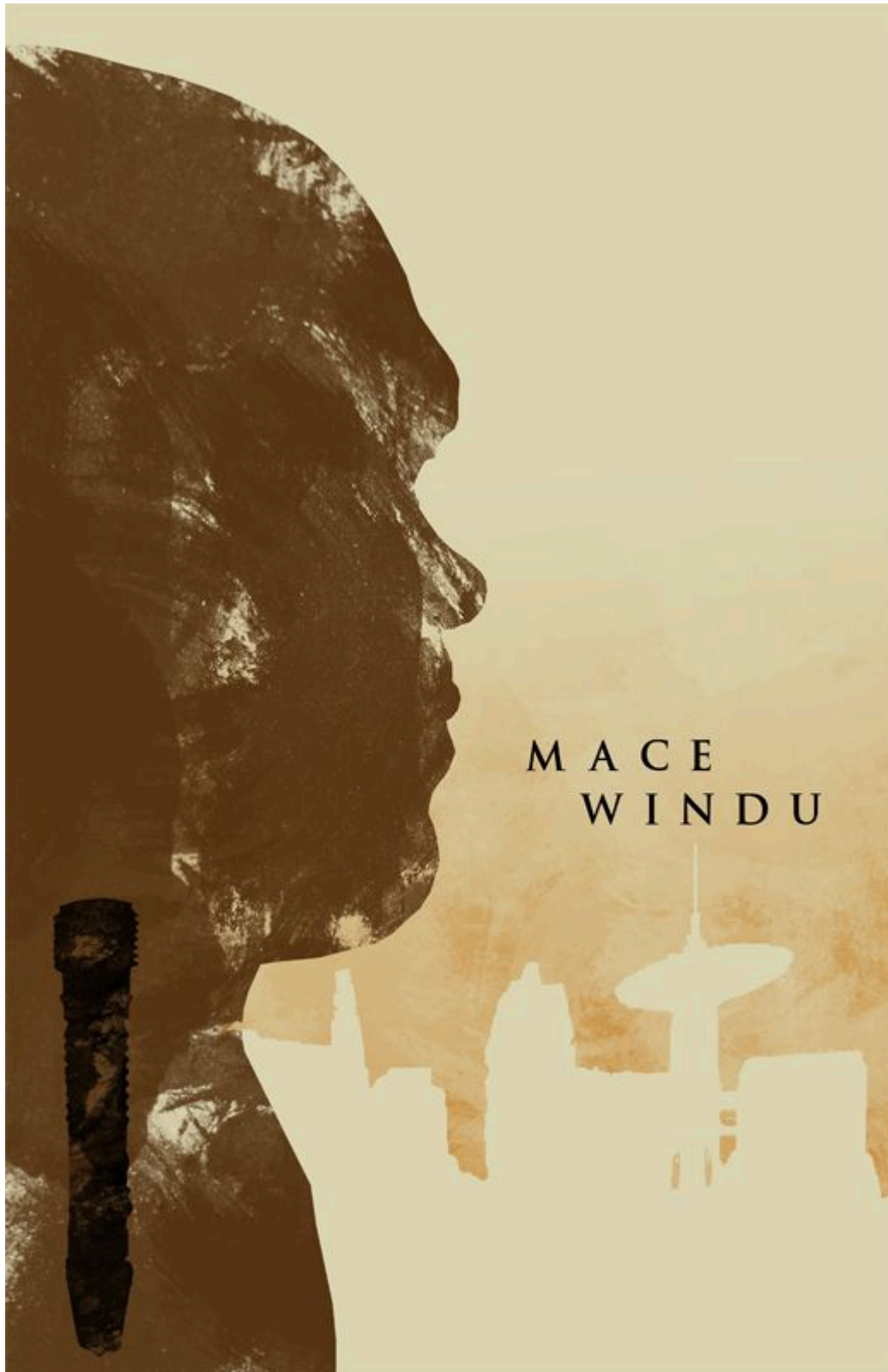
How to practice then (Sutra I.14)

I.14 "Sa tu dirghakala-nairantarya-satkara-asevito drdha-bhumi"

"But it is only a solid foundation if it is practiced with fervor, perseverance, uninterruptedly and for a long time."

Vairagya, **renunciation** is also very important in practice. **Letting go is essential** if you want to deepen your practice.

When we're practicing, we need to stay focused on what we're doing. The beneficial effects will be in vain if we allow ourselves to be distracted while performing the asanas (avoid looking at cell phones, watching TV, etc.).



"Once you know how to recognize the type of Vrittis, it would be easier to quiet them, and only then you would be able to merge with the Truth D.Force" Master Jedi D.Mace Windu

For the next course Read I.14,15,16

I.14 "But it is only a solid foundation if it is practiced with fervor, perseverance, uninterruptedly and for a long time."

I.15 "Renunciation is the practice of detachment from desires."

I.16 "The highest degree of letting go is detachment from the Gunas through Self-awareness."